

FULL NAME (pronouns - optional)

111 Any Street, Victoria BC V8K 1LM | (250) 123-4567 | lawstudent@uvic.ca

October 10, 2026

Contact Name, Title
Organization Name
Organization Address
City, Province Postal Code

Dear Firstname Lastname,

Re: 2027 Summer Student Position

Paragraph 1 – Introduction: The first paragraph simply states the position you are applying for and briefly introduces yourself, including your law school and current academic level (i.e., “I have recently completed my second year of studies at the University of Victoria Faculty of Law”). Do NOT start your letter with, “My name is ...”. When naming the position you are applying to, include the full name of the employer. You can then use a shortened version or acronym for the employer’s name for the rest of the letter. State your connection to the geographic location you are applying to. For students graduating at a different time that might seem “out-of-sync” from other law students, such as Co-op or JD/JID students, indicate your anticipated date of graduation. JD/JID students may also wish to include a brief description of the JID program.

Paragraph 2 – Why Are You Interested In This Employer: The second paragraph addresses why you are applying to this particular employer and how the position fits with your career goals. Do research on the organization (through the employer’s website, the Canadian Directory of Legal Employers, and networking) and refer to elements such as their mission or mandate, practice areas, culture, student programs, mentorship opportunities, pro bono work, or diversity policies. You may also wish to mention a firm’s size and type. For government, be sure to discuss your interest in public service. Customize this paragraph for each application. Refer to relevant past experiences briefly as proof of your interest in the things you claim interest in. If you have interacted with the employer, such as visiting their office, attending an event, or meeting one of their lawyers for an informational interview or “coffee chat”, mention it here. While this paragraph may feel similar for many employers, try to make it feel personal to each individual employer. Try to ensure the interest you are expressing is genuine.

Paragraph 3 – What You Have to Offer: The third paragraph connects your past work experience and skills to what the employer is looking for. Focus on key skills or competencies that are relevant to the employer’s work, or that are listed in the job posting, drawing from your work, volunteer, extracurricular, and personal experiences without repeating the content of your resume. For example, if you are applying to a litigation firm, draw attention to your moot court experience. A cleverly drafted cover letter will present past experiences, law-related or not, in a way that shows these transferrable skills. Don’t just list your skills without context. Consider the difference in the following statements: “I am a team player with efficient time-management and organizational skills” “Working as a student advisor to over 30 students, I developed my interpersonal skills and learned how to listen and meet people’s concerns. Furthermore, as a manager at a local restaurant, my responsibilities included scheduling, assigning tasks, and general employee motivation. From this experience, I gained valuable human resource experience, developed strong organizational and time management skills, and fostered my ability to be both a leader and a team player.”

Paragraph 4 – Conclusion: Conclude by thanking the reader for their time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Remember to sign your letter!

Your Typed name